



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Product/Service Management

APPAREL AND ACCESSORIES MARKETING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature and scope of the product/service management function.
2. Explain the nature of product/service branding.
3. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services.
4. Communicate core values of a product/service.
5. Identify components of a retail image.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the product development manager for URBAN GEAR, a brand that designs and sells outerwear and accessories for young adults who live in cities with unpredictable weather patterns. The head of product innovation (judge) has asked you to create a new product to add to the URBAN GEAR line and make decisions regarding its features, price, and target market.

URBAN GEAR is known for producing high-quality jackets, coats, and weather-resistant accessories such as gloves, scarves, and hats. The company prides itself on functionality and style, with an emphasis on products that can adapt to sudden changes in weather. The products appeal to Gen Z and Millennial consumers who value durability, fashion, and sustainability.

In recent surveys, customers have expressed interest in products that help them manage the rapid transitions between warm and cold weather. Some customers have even requested hybrid outerwear that can be easily transformed or adjusted to suit various weather conditions without sacrificing style. The company currently does not offer anything like this.

The head of product innovation (judge) wants you to propose a new product that meets these needs. You should consider the following:

- What type of product will you develop?
- What unique features will this product offer?
- Who is the primary target market?
- What should the price range be to ensure competitiveness while maintaining the brand's upscale positioning?
- How will this product fit into the overall URBAN GEAR brand?

You will present your product concept and strategy to the head of product innovation (judge) in a role-play to take place in their office. The head of product innovation (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your product concept and have answered the head of product innovation's (judge's) questions, the head of product innovation will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What marketing strategies do you propose to highlight the unique features of this product to both current customers and new potential buyers in the Gen Z and Millennial demographic?
2. How do you see this product expanding or enhancing the URBAN GEAR brand's reputation for innovation and adaptability in the outerwear market?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature and scope of the product/service management function?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain the nature of product/service branding?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Communicate core values of a product/service?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Identify components of a retail image?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						